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Privacy & Personally Identifying Information Policy

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1. Objective

The Partners Privacy & Personally Identifiable Information Policy sets forth the minimum standards for Partners to protect personally identifiable information (“PII”) and outlines how and why Partners collects, processes, and handles PII. This policy also informs individuals about their rights regarding data privacy. This policy applies to personal data provided to Partners, both by individuals themselves and/or by others. This policy is created to be transparent about why and how Partners process personal data. These standards are cast as practices; they represent the set of expectations against which policy compliance will be assessed. Further obligations imposed by law, regulations, contract, or other institutional policies also apply.

2. Definition

Personally Identifiable Information (PII) is defined in [OMB Memorandum M-07-16](#) refers to information that can be used to *distinguish or trace* an individual’s identity, either alone or when combined with other personal or identifying information that is *linked* or linkable to a specific individual. Further, PII is defined as information: (i) that directly identifies an individual (i.e., name, address, social security number or other identifying number or code, telephone number, email address, etc.) or (ii) by which Partners intends to identify specific individuals in conjunction with other data elements, i.e., indirect identification. The definition of PII is not anchored to any single category of information or technology. Rather, it requires a case-by-case assessment of the specific risk that an individual can be identified. In performing this assessment, it is important for Partners to recognize that non-PII can become PII whenever additional information is made publicly available in any medium and from any source that, when combined with other available information, could be used to identify an individual.

To *distinguish* an individual is to identify an individual. Some examples of information that could identify an individual include, but are not limited to, name, passport number, social security number, or biometric data.

To *trace* an individual is to process sufficient information to make a determination about a specific aspect of an individual’s activities or status.

Linked information is information about or related to an individual that is logically associated with other information about the individual. In contrast, *linkable* information is information about or related to an individual for which there is a possibility of logical association with other information about the individual.

3. Applicability

This policy applies to all Partners employees, contractors, board members, and all other individuals or entities working with Partners who have access to PII.

4. Collecting of Personally Identifiable Information

Partners will only collect personal information where the data is reasonably necessary for a specific business-related purposes. Collected data should be appropriate for the intended authorized use, and collection should be conducted according to legal requirements for the type and purpose of data collected. The purposes for which PII is collected should be specified at the time of data collection and the subsequent use limited to the fulfillment of those purposes. PII should not be disclosed, made available or otherwise used for purposes other than those specified, except with the consent of the individual or by legal authority.

PII data is typically collected directly from individuals for the agreed purposes of contracting, employment, consideration for employment, potentially receiving services from a vendor, receiving services from a vendor, or keeping parties' information on Partners' work.

The types of Personal Information we may collect includes but is not limited to:

- Name and gender
- Date of Birth
- Mailing Address
- Personal contact details (i.e. telephone, email, or fax number)
- Occupation, references and previous employment history, qualifications, and skills
- Information provided through our website, Facebook, Twitter accounts or other social media
- Information provided through other public media forums (e.g. LinkedIn, Humentum, etc.)
- Contractual and performance history with Partners

Partners collects personal information in a lawful and fair manner and will only be obtained from individuals if it is deemed reasonable and practicable. Partners collect this information in a variety of ways, including but not limited to:

- Applications or responses submitted to employment advertisements;
- Enquiries made through Partners websites and comments made through Partners websites or social media platforms;
- When someone follows our social media accounts, and registers or subscribes to our mailing list;
- Through government agencies or third-party reporting services as legally required;
- Applications submitted to attend events such as conferences, meetings, and trainings;
- Photos and videos of attendance at training or similar sessions (individuals will be given a chance at the session to ask not to be videoed or photographed);
- Details of any disabilities and any accommodations in order for Partners to make accommodations in the workplace or at event sites;



- Partners may also collect sensitive personal information where we are permitted to do so by law (e.g. criminal record activity following stringent vetting processes) and information related to health; and
- Through direct communication between an individual and Partners personnel, such as email, mail, by telephone and direct meetings.

Partners primarily relies on the consent of individuals to collect, process, and hold their data. Individual may opt not to provide consent or not provide certain personal information requested; however, doing so may result in Partners inability to provide an individual with a service or contract. Partners strives to keep the personal data we hold relevant, updated, and correct. If there is a change in personal data, please inform Partners so that we may update the information as relevant.

4.1 Information Collected on Partners' Website

Partners collects anonymized data about visitors to its websites. The primary goal in collecting this information is to provide the user with the most useful content and services. No PII is collected or maintained without the user's consent. Partners uses HTTP cookies to improve the performance of our site. All retained data is anonymized no PII is collected, stored, or placed in cookies that can be accessed by third parties.

4.2 Images Utilized by Partners

Partners utilizes images collected by staff to demonstrate the nature and impact of Partners' work. Partners seeks consent to the degree practical from the individuals depicted in these images. If any individual is reproduced in any of the images hosted on a Partners website, social media platforms, etc. and would like these images to be deleted, please follow the contact procedure in section [13. Policy Contact Information](#) and the images will be promptly removed.

5. Use of Personal Data

All individuals with access to PII must make every effort to limit the use of PII and minimizing aggregations of PII. When PII is necessary, Partners use the personal information for the following purposes:

- Providing services;
- Assessing suitability for potential employment or contractual engagement;
- Employing or contracting;
- Receiving services;
- Submission of documents to donors;
- Keeping parties informed about Partners' work; and
- Compliance with relevant laws or other legal requirements.

6. Sharing of Personally Identifiable Information

Partners will only share personal information with others when legally permitted. Partners includes contractual language with third parties regarding confidentiality and data protection. Personal data and information that Partners holds may be transferred to the following types of organizations:

- Third-party organizations that provide support services (i.e. payroll, IT, travel, health insurance, retirement accounts). Third party contractors to whom Partners is disclosing PII must be bound by agreements with appropriate PII safeguarding and use provisions;
- Professional advisors, such as lawyers, auditors, and accountants;
- Law enforcement, government, or other regulatory agencies as provided for by law.

Partners does not sell your personal data to any third parties.

PII may not be shared to external parties outside Partners (i.e. via mail, fax, e-mail, etc.) without appropriate security controls. Generally, such controls include encryption and authentication of recipients. Some example of controls include, but are not limited to, password protection of files; marking documents as confidential, use of encrypted emails such as Virtu.

7. Protocols for Securing PII

To protect PII against inappropriate access, use, disclosure, or transmission, Partners requires appropriate administrative, technical, and physical safeguards. All staff are expected to follow the below procedure in securing information.

7.1 Securing of Physical PII

- Partners requires physically securing PII (i.e., in a locked drawer, cabinet, desk, or safe) when not in use or not otherwise under the control of a person with a need to know. PII may be stored in a space where access control measures are employed to prevent unauthorized access by members of the public or other persons without a need to know.
- Never leave PII unattended on a desk, network printer, fax machine, or copier.
- Never leave PII in hard copy unattended and unsecured.

7.2 Securing of Electronic PII

- Lock your computer when you leave your desk. Depending on your equipment, you may lock your computer by (1) holding down “C”+ “L”, (2) holding down “Ctrl”+ “Alt” + “Delete” and then hitting “Enter.”
- Use a “time-out” function for remote access, work on computers/laptops, and mobile devices requiring user re-authentication after thirty minutes of inactivity;
- Do not permit your computer to remember passwords.
- Use a privacy screen if you regularly access PII in an unsecured area where those without a need to know or members of the public can see your screen, such as in a reception area.



- Personally owned computers should not be used to save, store, or host PII.
- Do not forward emails containing PII to your personal email account (e.g., your Yahoo, Gmail, or Hotmail e-mail account) so that you can work on it on your home computer.
- Store PII on SharePoint and ensure access is restricted to those with a need to know by permissions settings or passwords.
- Do not post PII on the multi-access calendars, or on the Internet (including social networking sites) that can be accessed by individuals who do not have a “need to know.”

7.3 Securing of PII on Travel

- When on travel and using a Partners laptop or other company devices to access and/or store PII, this device must be secured while in transit.
- Never pack Partners laptops or electronic storage devices in checked baggage or leave them in a car for an extended period of time where they can be stolen and/or disappear.
 - If you must leave it in a car, lock it in the trunk so that it is out of sight.
 - Do not leave your laptop or other company device in a car overnight.
 - Do not store a Partners laptop or other company device in an airport, a train or bus station, or any public locker.

7.4 Securing of Verbal PII

- Caution is required in all oral communications involving PII, and oral communications involving PII may not take place in any location where the communication may be overheard by an individual not authorized to access the PII.
- Avoid discussing PII in person or over the telephone when you’re within earshot of anyone who does not need to know the information.
 - Keep in mind that phone conversations are easily overheard between desks/offices, so PII is most securely discussed in an office or conference room behind a closed door.

8. Retention of Personally Identifiable Information

Partners does not intend to keep PII for longer than reasonably required. The duration depends on the nature of the personal data and the purposes for which it was received. Partners’ data retention policy informed by:

- Legal or regulatory requirements of the location of the data processing;
- The completion of a contract or employment engagement;
- If personal data is held for reasons other than legal requirement or contractual engagement (i.e. newsletter, membership database, recruitment database, etc.), Partners will maintain that data until a request is made for removal or correction.



All PII should be stored electronically on SharePoint in restricted access folders and files. In accordance with Partners Record Retention Policy, unit directors will be responsible for monitoring how long information including PII must be retained before requiring deletion or destruction. Any PII stored on mobile devices or other at-risk devices such as a shared workstations must use encryption (if not on SharePoint).

9. Destruction of PII

PII must be destroyed and rendered unreadable prior to disposal. For example, this may include shredding papers or wiping electronic files.

10. Breaches of Privacy of PII

A breach is the actual or suspected compromise, unauthorized disclosure, unauthorized acquisition, unauthorized access, and/or any similar occurrence where:

1. A person other than an authorized user accesses or potentially accesses PII, or
2. An authorized user accesses or potentially accesses PII for other than an authorized purpose.

Partners applies best business practices and secure systems to protect PII. If a data breach that included PII were to occur, Partners will respond to the breach as required by the relevant regulations.

Known or suspected violations of this policy should be reported promptly to the Chief Financial Officer or any other member of senior management. Any incidents that have the potential to damage Partners network operations should be reported immediately. Violators of this policy may be subject to criminal and/or civil penalties and to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

11. Training

Partners users of PII will be required to complete a training (on-demand) on the proper use and handling of PII. In addition, all users will be required to signed confidentiality agreements before accessing, using, sharing, handling, or receiving PII.

12. Rights for Personal Identifying Information

Partners will honor legal requirements regarding PII. As part of Partners transparency, all individuals are entitled to the following rights under Partners Privacy & PII Policy:

- *Right to Access* – Subject to certain conditions, individuals are entitled to have access to your personal data. Individuals may contact Partners to request a copy of your personal data held by Partners.



- *Right to Data Portability* – Subject to certain conditions, individuals are entitled to receive the personal data which you have provided to Partners, and which is processed by automated means, in a structured, commonly-used machine readable format.
- *Right to Correction* – Individuals may challenge the accuracy or completeness of your personal data and have it corrected or completed, as applicable. Each individual has the responsibility to help keep your personal information accurate and up to date.
- *Right to Object to or Restrict Processing* – Subject to certain conditions, individuals have the right to object to or ask us to restrict the processing of your personal data.
- *Right of Erasure* – Subject to certain conditions, you are entitled to have your personal data erased (i.e. where your personal data is no longer needed for the it purposes was collected, or where the relevant processing is unlawful).
- *Right to Withdraw Consent* – As stated above, where Partners processing of your personal data is based on your consent you have the right to withdraw your consent at any time. If you withdraw your consent, this will only take effect for future processing and is subject to certain conditions based on Partners' legal obligations.

To act on any of the above rights, Partners may need to request additional information regarding the specifics of the request as well as confirm your identity. Partners will respond to these requests once we confirm the validity of the request.

13. Policy Contact Information

If you would like additional details regarding Partners privacy and PII, report a violation, or exercise your right under this policy, please contact compliance@partners.net.